Recording readiness inventory â€” Boba client surfaces + HelixAgent ensemble + per-surface recording plan

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-15T00:00:00Z **Scope:** Feasibility for Â§11.4.153/.154/.155 video-recording confirmation of ALL Boba client apps, driven by the HelixAgent ensemble, saved to `/Volumes/T7/Downloads/Recordings` with a `boba---` prefix. Anti-bluff (Â§11.4.6): EXISTS/ABSENT claims below carry path evidence; unknowns are marked UNCONFIRMED.

---

1. Client-surface inventory (EXISTS / DOES-NOT-EXIST, with evidence)

Surface	Status	Evidence / path	Notes
Web â€” Angular dashboard	**EXISTS**	`frontend/` (`angular.json`, `frontend/package.json` name=`frontend`, `frontend/playwright.config.ts`, `frontend/e2e/`)	Angular 21 SPA. Playwright already configured for e2e â†' ideal recording driver. Routes incl.Â `/jackett`.
Web â€” FastAPI Jinja2 dashboard (:7187)	**EXISTS**	merge service dashboard at `http://localhost:7187/` (CLAUDE.md port map; served by `download-proxy/src/api/`)	Server-rendered HTML dashboard, separate from the Angular SPA. Browser-recordable.
CLI â€” `boba-ctl`	**EXISTS (CLI, not TUI)**	`cmd/boba-ctl/main.go` (built binary `cmd/boba-ctl/boba-ctl`), wrapper `scripts/boba-ctl.sh`	Subcommand CLI: `up/down/status/health/list`. **NO TUI** â€” no bubbletea/tview/textual dep in `cmd/boba-ctl/go.mod`. The operatorâ€™s â€œboba-ctl TUI?â€� â†' it is a plain CLI. Record via terminal capture.
Shell-script CLIs	**EXISTS**	`start.sh`, `stop.sh`, `setup.sh`, `test.sh`, `ci.sh`, `install-plugin.sh`, `webui-bridge.py`	Operator-facing command surfaces; terminal-recordable.
	EXISTS		

Surface	Status	Evidence / path	Notes
Browser extension â€” BobaLink		`extension/` (WXT/ Manifest V3, `extension/wxt.config.ts` name â€œBobaLink (Boba Project browser extension)â€�, `extension/playwright.config.ts`, `extension/tests/`)	MV3 extension, popup/background. Scoped to merge service `localhost:7187`. Record popup + content via Playwright-with-extension / chrome-devtools.
TUI (dedicated terminal UI app)	**DOES-NOT-EXIST**	grep for bubbletea/tview/ textual/blessed â†’ no Boba hit (only test files / a course demo.sh)	No TUI surface. If the operator wants a â€œTUIâ€�, boba-ctl CLI is the closest existing surface.
Mobile app (iOS/ Android/Flutter)	**DOES-NOT-EXIST**	no `*.swift` / `*.kt` / `*.dart` / `Info.plist` in repo (excluding submodules/ node_modules)	No mobile surface to record.
Desktop native (Electron/Tauri)	**DOES-NOT-EXIST**	no `electron`/`tauri` dep in `frontend/package.json` or `extension/package.json`	The â€œdesktopâ€� surface is the web dashboard in a browser, not a native app.

Bottom line: 4 real recordable client surfaces â€” (1) Angular web `frontend/`, (2) FastAPI Jinja2 dashboard :7187, (3) `boba-ctl` CLI + shell scripts, (4) BobaLink browser extension. **No** TUI, **no** mobile, **no** desktop-native app. Do NOT produce recordings for apps that donâ€™t exist (Â§11.4.6).

---

2. HelixAgent ensemble location â€” THE KEY BLOCKER

The operator wants recordings â€œdriven by the helix agent ensemble obtained from the helix agent Submoduleâ€�.

Finding (FACT, with evidence): - The ensemble IS present on the host at `/Volumes/T7/Projects/helix_code/submodules/helix_agent` (EXISTS â€” verified). It is **HelixAgent: AI-Powered Ensemble LLM Service** (its `README.md` H1), a Go service with entrypoints `bin/helixagent`, `cmd/api`, `cmd/grpc-server`, `cmd/mcp-bridge`, `cmd/helixagent`. Catalogue: `vasic-digital/HelixAgent` + `HelixDevelopment/HelixAgent` (â€œLLMs Agentâ€�). - Its containers ARE running: `helixagent-postgres`, `helixagent-redis`, `helixagent-chromadb`, `helixagent-cognee` (compose project `helix_agent`, config `/Volumes/T7/Projects/helix_code/submodules/helix_agent/docker-compose.yml`), plus `helix_ollama_video` (an Ollama instance, 6h uptime â€” plausibly the vision/video-analysis model host, UNCONFIRMED which model it serves). - **BLOCKER 1:** the ensemble is owned by `helix_code`**, NOT by Boba**. It is NOT in Bobaâ€™s `.gitmodules` (Bobaâ€™s submodules are only: constitution, jackett, helixqa, challenges, containers). To use it per the constitution it must be incorporated into Boba per Â§11.4.74 (catalogue-first) + Â§11.4.36 (install_upstreams on add) â€” OR consumed as a running service via its API/gRPC/MCP endpoints without a submodule. The operatorâ€™s phrase â€œobtained from the helix agent Submoduleâ€� implies incorporation; that decision is operator-gated. - **BLOCKER 2 (interface UNCONFIRMED):** how exactly the ensemble ingests a VIDEO file and returns a per-feature analysis verdict is not yet verified. `helix_ollama_video` suggests a vision pipeline exists, but the concrete â€œanalyse this mp4 â†’ JSON verdictâ€� entrypoint (API route / CLI flag / MCP tool) was NOT confirmed in this pass. The main agent must verify the ensembleâ€™s video-analysis API before the Â§11.4.153 (4) remediation loop can be wired.

docs_chain (the Â§11.4.153 (5) sync engine) â€” secondary blocker: - `docs_chain` EXISTS at `/Volumes/T7/Projects/docs_chain` AND `/Volumes/T7/Projects/helix_code/submodules/docs_chain`, but is **NOT a Boba submodule** (absent from Boba `.gitmodules`). Â§11.4.106 requires consuming it by reference; Boba must wire it (register `.docs_chain/contexts/*.yaml`) before the always-in-sync clause holds.

---

3. Recording-corpus state + project-name prefix

- Recording path `/Volumes/T7/Downloads/Recordings` **EXISTS**. It currently holds `helixcode-*` files (mp4/png/.cast) â€” another projectâ€™s recordings. **No `boba-*` / `boba---*` recordings yet.**
- **Prefix to use** = `boba` (Â§11.4.155 resolution): `HELIX_RELEASE_PREFIX` is **NOT set** in Bobaâ€™s `.env` or `.env.example` â†’ fallback to lowercased snake_case repo-dir name â†’ repo dir is lowercase `boba`. Canonical filename form: `boba---<surface-or-feature>---<run-id>.<ext>` (triple-hyphen separator per Â§11.4.155). Recommend setting `HELIX_RELEASE_PREFIX=boba` in `.env` explicitly so the prefix is authoritative and matches Â§11.4.151 release-tag prefix.
- Â§11.4.154 fresh-corpus rotation applies only to Bobaâ€™s OWN prior `boba---*` recordings â€” the existing `helixcode-*` files are FOREIGN and MUST NOT be deleted (Â§11.4.122 + Â§9.2).

---

4. Per-surface recording recommendation

Surface	Recommended capture mechanism	Window-scoped (Â§11.4.154)	Notes
Angular web `frontend/`	**Playwright** (already configured: `frontend/playwright.config.ts`) with `video: 'on'` / `recordVideo`, OR chrome-devtools-mcp `performance_start_trace` + screen-record of the tab	Yes â€” Playwright records the page viewport only, not the desktop	Strongest path; e2e specs already exist in `frontend/e2e/`.
FastAPI Jinja2 dashboard :7187	Playwright / chrome-devtools-mcp against `http://localhost:7187/`	Yes â€” browser viewport	Needs containers up (`boba-ctl up` / `start.sh`).
BobaLink extension	Playwright with the unpacked extension loaded (`.output/`) â†’ record popup + content-script interaction; or chrome-devtools-mcp	Yes â€” browser/popup window	`extension/playwright.config.ts` + `extension/tests/` already exist.

Surface	Recommended capture mechanism	Window-scoped (Â§11.4.154)	Notes
`boba-ctl` CLI + shell scripts	**asciinema** (`asciinema rec`) â†' convert to mp4 via `agg`/ `ffmpeg`; or `script` + `ffmpeg`. (Existing `helixcode-cli-*.cast` files show asciinema is already the hostâ€™s CLI-recording tool.)	Yes â€" record the terminal pane only (tmux target / window id), NOT the whole desktop	Window-scope = single terminal window; do NOT `ffmpeg -f avfoundation` whole-screen.

All four are window/surface-scoped by construction (Playwright = viewport, asciinema = terminal pane), so Â§11.4.154 is naturally satisfied â€" provided the asciinemaâ†'mp4 step captures only the terminal, and no whole-screen `avfoundation` fallback is used.

---

5. What the main agent must resolve with the operator (blockers)

1. **Incorporate HelixAgent ensemble + docs_chain into Boba** (per Â§11.4.74 + Â§11.4.36 + Â§11.4.106) â€" or confirm â€œconsume as running service via API/gRPC/MCP, no submoduleâ€�. Operator-gated decision.
2. **Confirm the ensembleâ€™s video-analysis interface** (the mp4 â†' verdict entrypoint) before wiring the Â§11.4.153 (4) loop â€" UNCONFIRMED in this pass.
3. **Confirm `helix_ollama_video` is the intended vision model host** for video analysis â€" UNCONFIRMED.
4. **Decide PART 1 path** (Option A project-instantiation vs Option B Â§11.4.153 refinement) â€" the rule already exists; a new Â§11.4.156 would duplicate Â§11.4.153/.154/.155.